Hope Hospital		**Written Guidance on Management of Medications Brought from Outside**
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	Created by Quality Coordinator Signature/Name: Dr. Darpan Jakkal,	**Guidance and Approved by Director** Signature/Name: Dr. B K Murali

1. Purpose

To ensure safe, appropriate, and accountable use of medications brought from outside (home or external pharmacies) by patients during hospitalization or treatment, while minimizing risks of medication errors or adverse events.

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2. Scope

This guidance applies to all healthcare professionals involved in medication management, including physicians, pharmacists, and nursing staff, in inpatient and outpatient settings.

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3. Definition

Medications brought from outside refers to:

- Drugs brought by the patient from home at the time of admission
- Medications purchased by the patient from external sources during treatment (not issued by hospital pharmacy)

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4. Policy Statement

- The organization allows the use of medications brought from outside **only when clinically justified and approved** by the treating physician.
- All such medications must be **verified by the hospital pharmacy** and **documented appropriately**.
- Expired, unlabelled, or unidentified medications **shall not be used** under any circumstances.

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5. Procedure

A. At the Time of Admission

1. Nursing staff must:
    - Ask the patient or caregiver about any medications brought from home.
    - List and notify the treating physician.
2. The physician must:
    - Review the external medications.
    - Decide whether to continue, substitute, or stop them.
3. The pharmacy must:
    - Verify the identity, integrity, and expiry of the medications.
    - Label them appropriately if being continued.
4. Documentation:
    - Record in the **Medication Reconciliation Form**.
    - Entry must be made in the **Medication Administration Record (MAR)** clearly stating the source.

B. Storage

- Approved medications brought from outside must be stored:
    - In a clearly labeled container (with patient name and drug name)
    - In the nursing station medication cabinet or a patient-specific locker
- They must be **separated from hospital-issued medications** to prevent mix-ups.

C. Administration

- Only nursing staff may administer such medications after:
    - Verifying with the prescription
    - Documenting time, dose, and source
- Self-administration is **not allowed** unless explicitly permitted (refer to self-administration policy).

D. Refill or Continuation

- If such medications are to be continued and run out:
    - Physician must write a prescription
    - Medication should preferably be dispensed by the **hospital pharmacy** or as per hospital policy
    - All purchases from outside must be documented

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6. Medications Not Permitted for Use

- Expired medications
- Drugs without proper labeling or identity
- Herbal products or alternative medicines unless approved
- Damaged or improperly stored items
- High-risk or controlled substances (unless verified and approved)

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7. Disposal of Unused Medications

- On discharge or death:
    - Unused external medications must be returned to the patient or caregiver.
    - If abandoned or unclaimed, dispose of as per hospital's drug disposal policy.

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8. Responsibilities

Department	Responsibilities
Nursing	Initial identification, storage, and administration documentation
Physician	Clinical decision on usage
Pharmacy	Verification, labeling, and tracking
Quality Team	Audits and compliance monitoring